

Everyday Soul — CyberScrolls Series

EP10 – Anchor the Logs

By Helen Najar | Lionheart

A practical guide to protecting your financial identity and anchoring the records written under your name.



⚡ Quick Actions — If You Only Do One Thing

1. Create accounts with **all three bureaus**: Experian, TransUnion, & Equifax.
2. **Enable a credit freeze** with each bureau
3. **Store your bureau logins securely**
4. **Check your credit report once per year**
5. **Temporarily lift the freeze** when applying for credit
6. **Re-enable the freeze** once the process is complete

*Security is not fear. It is stewardship.
Read the full steps below.*

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Full Guide — Detailed Steps

1. Why Identity Theft IS Quiet

Most people imagine cyber threats as loud events — alarms, warnings, hacked screens.

Identity theft rarely looks like that.

It happens silently through financial systems:

- Someone opens a credit card in your name
- A loan appears under your identity
- Debt builds before you ever see it

By the time you notice, the record has already been written.

This is why the logs must be anchored.

2. The Three Record Keepers

In the United States, three major bureaus maintain your credit history:

- **Experian**
- **TransUnion**
- **Equifax**

These organizations track:

- Credit cards, Loans, Payment history, Credit inquiries, Debt balances

Lenders use these reports to decide:

- Whether you qualify for credit
- What interest rates you receive
- Sometimes even housing approvals

These records shape financial movement.

3. Understanding the Credit Report

Your **credit report** is the ledger of your financial identity.

It includes:

- Active accounts
- Closed accounts
- Hard inquiries
- Payment history
- Public records such as collections

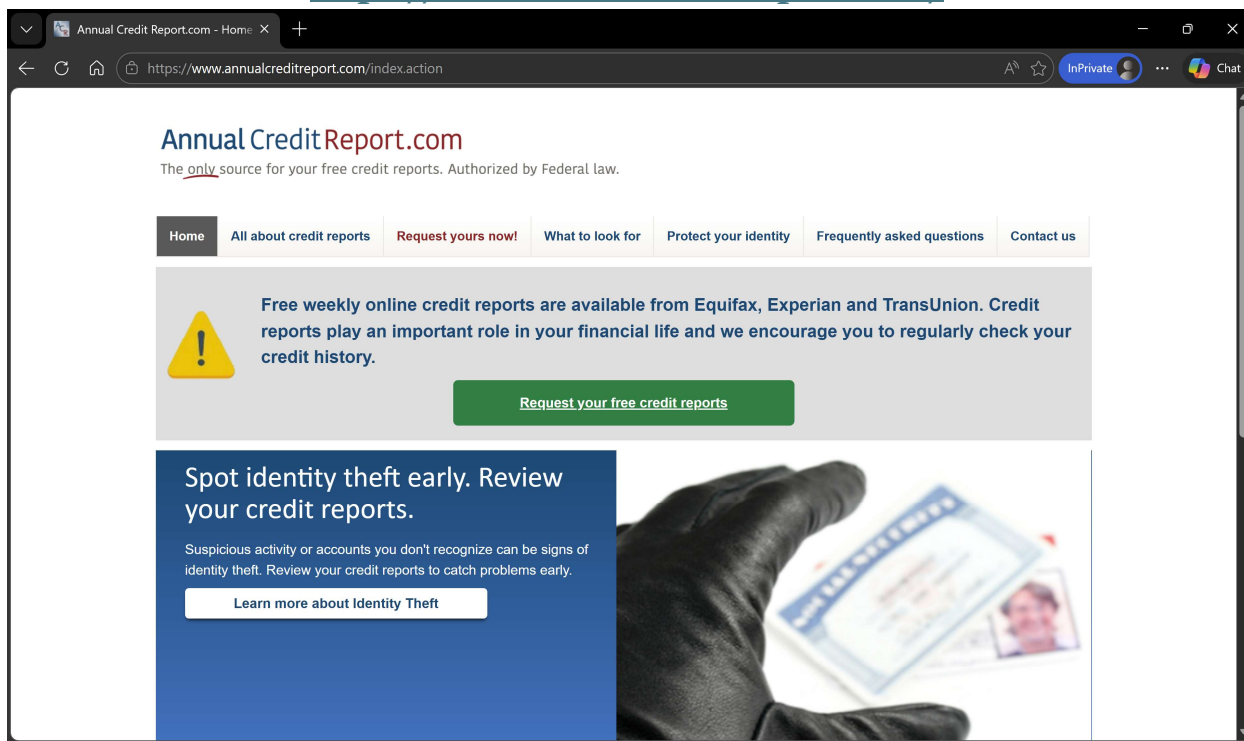
Mistakes or fraudulent accounts here can affect:

- Credit approval
- Loan eligibility
- Interest rates

This is why reviewing your report matters.

You are allowed **one free credit report per bureau each year**.

Official site: <https://www.annualcreditreport.com/>



Know what is written under your name.

4. What a Credit Freeze Does

A **credit freeze** locks your credit file.

When a freeze is active:

- Lenders cannot access your credit report
- New credit accounts cannot be opened
- Fraudulent applications are blocked

Your existing accounts remain unaffected.

Your credit score also **does not change**.

Think of it as lowering the harbor chains.

Ships may approach —

But none dock without your command.

5. How to Freeze Your Credit

You must freeze your credit with **each bureau individually**.

Experian

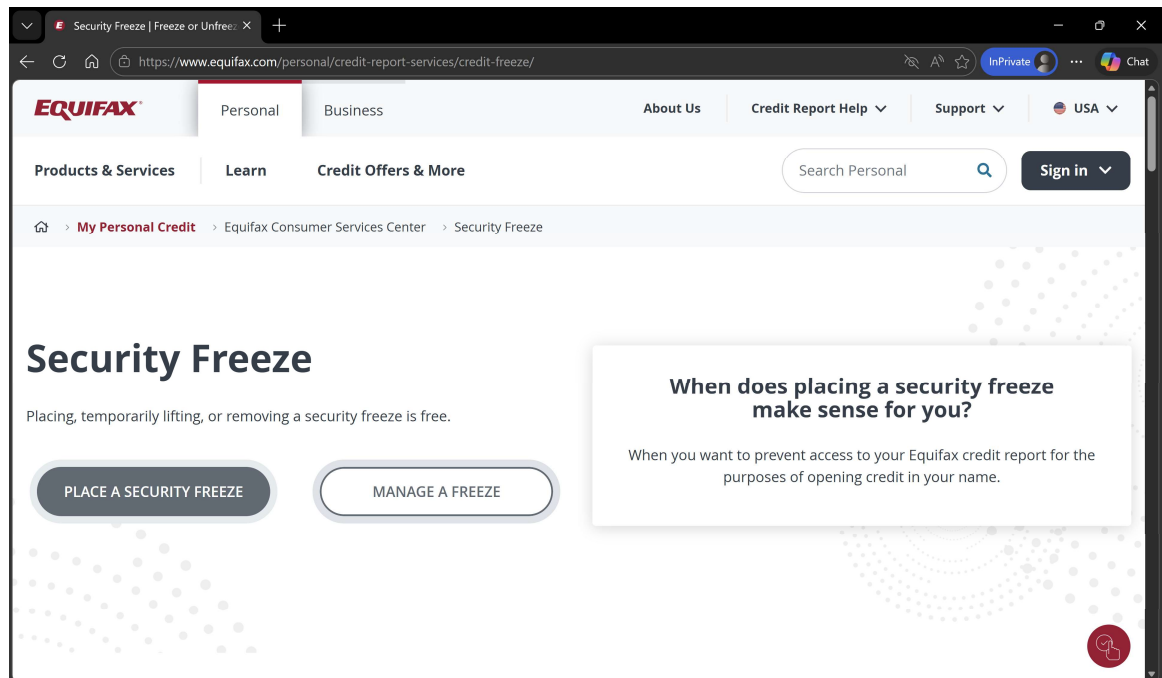
- <https://www.experian.com/freeze>

TransUnion

- <https://www.transunion.com/credit-freeze>

Equifax

- <https://www.equifax.com/personal/credit-report-services/credit-freeze/>



Lower the harbor chains. No new accounts without your command.

Each service allows you to:

- Activate the freeze
- Temporarily lift the freeze
- Permanently remove the freeze

The process is free.

6. When to Lift a Freeze

You may temporarily lift a freeze when applying for:

- Credit cards
- Auto loans
- Mortgages
- Apartment leases
- Certain background checks

After approval, you can re-enable the freeze.
Security returns immediately.

7. Freeze vs Fraud Alert

Some people use **fraud alerts** instead.

Fraud alerts:

- Notify lenders to verify identity
- Still allow credit checks

Credit freeze is stronger.

It prevents the credit check entirely.
Quiet protection often works best.

8. Review the Ledger

Even with freeze, review your credit reports periodically.

Look for:

- Accounts you don't recognize
- Unexpected inquiries
- Incorrect balances
- Personal information errors

Your identity deserves attention.
Know what is written under your name.

9. Reflection — the Lionheart reminder

“Some logs tell the story of where you’ve sailed.
Others decide where you’re allowed to go.
Anchor them well.”

Appendix — Credit Bureau Links

- **Experian:**
 - <https://www.experian.com/freeze>
 - **TransUnion:**
 - <https://www.transunion.com/credit-freeze>
 - **Equifax:**
 - <https://www.equifax.com/personal/credit-report-services/credit-freeze/>
 - **Annual Credit Report** (official government-authorized site)
 - <https://www.annualcreditreport.com>
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Appendix — Credit Bureau Links

You do not have to rely only on websites.

All three major credit bureaus offer official mobile apps that allow you to manage your credit freeze directly from your phone.

Install the official apps from your device's app store:

- **Experian**
- **TransUnion**
- **Equifax**

Once installed, you can:

- Enable or disable your credit freeze
- Temporarily lift a freeze when applying for credit
- Re-enable the freeze when finished
- Monitor important credit alerts

Having these apps available means your credit controls remain within easy reach whenever you need them.

Security does not have to be complicated — sometimes it simply needs to be accessible when the moment arrives.